RESOLUTION MEPC.56(33)
(adopted on 30 October 1992)
ADOPTION OF AMENDMENTS TO THE CODE FOR THE CONSTRUCTION AND EQUIPMENT OF SHIPS CARRYING DANGEROUS CHEMICALS IN BULK (BCH CODE)RESOLUTION MEPC.56 (3})
(adopte d on }O Octobe r 1992)
ADOPTION OF AMENDMENTS TO THE CODE FOR THE CONSTRUCTION AND EQUIPMENT OF SHIPS CARRYING DANGEROUS CHEMICALS IN BULK (BCH CODE)
THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE,
RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee conferred upon it by internationa l conventions for the prevention and control of marine pollution,
NOTING article 16 of the Internati onal Conven tion for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973 (hereinafter referred to as the "1973 Convention") and article VI of the Protocol of 1978 relating to the International Conventi on for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973 (he rei nafter referred to as the "1978 Protocol"), which together specify the amendment procedure of the 1978 Protocol and co nfer upon the appropriate body o f the Organization the function of considering and adopting amendment s t o the

referred to as the "1978 Protocol"), which together specify the amendment procedure of the 1978 Protocol and co nfer upon the appropriate body o f the Organization the function of considering and adopting amendment s t o the 1973 Convention, a9 modified by the 1978 Pr ot ocol (MARPOL 73/78),
NOTING FURTHER resolution HEPC.55(3}) by which the Committee adopted amendments to th e International Code for the Construction and Equipment of Ships Carrying Dangerous Chemicals in Bulk (IBC Code).
RECOGNIZING the need to bring the correspond ing amendments to the BCR Code into force on the date on which the amendments to the IBC Code enter into force,
HAVING CONSIDERED, at its thirty-third session , the amendments to the BCR Code prop ose d by the Sub-Committee on Bulk Chemicals at its twenty-first session and circulated in accorda nce with article 16(2)(a) of the 197} Convention,
1. ADOPTS in accordance with article 16(2)(d) of the 1973 Convention amendments to the BeR Code, the text of which is set out in the annex to the present resolution;
2. DETERMINES, in accordance with article l6(2)(f)(iii) o f the

1. ADOPTS in accordance with article 16(2)(d) of the 1973 Convention amendments to the BeR Code, the text of which is set out in the annex to the present resolution;
2. DETERMINES, in accordance with article l6(2)(f)(iii) o f the 1973 Convention, that the amendments shall be deemed to ha ve been acce pted on the date on which the conditions for the entry into force of the amendments to the IBC Code adopted by the Committee by resolution MEPC.5S(33) are met, unless, prior to that date, not less than one third of the Parties or the Parties, the combined merchant fleets of which constitute not le ss than fifty per cent of the gross tonnage of the world's merchant fleet, have communicated to the Organization their objections to the amendments;
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3. INVITES the Parties to note that, in accordance with article 16(2)(g)(ii) of the 1973 Convention, the amendments shall enter into force six months after their acceptance in accordance with paragraph 2 above;

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3. INVITES the Parties to note that, in accordance with article 16(2)(g)(ii) of the 1973 Convention, the amendments shall enter into force six months after their acceptance in accordance with paragraph 2 above;
4. REQUESTS the Secretary-General, in conformity with article 16(Z)(e) of the 1973 Convention, to transmit to all Parties to the 1978 Protocol certified co pies of the present resolution and the text of the amendments contained in the annex;
5. REQUESTS FURTHER the Secretary-General to transmit to the Members of the Organi~ation which are not Parties to the 1978 Protocol copies of the resolution and its annex.
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CHEMICALS IN BULK (BCH CODE)- 3 -
ANNEX
AMENDMENTS TO THE BCH CODE
The existing text of the last sentence of 1.1 is amended by addition of the following words:
of chapter 17 of the IBC Code.
The last two sentences of the existing text of 1.2.1 is amended to read as follows:
The Code is at present limited to the liquids shown in the summary of

following words:
of chapter 17 of the IBC Code.
The last two sentences of the existing text of 1.2.1 is amended to read as follows:
The Code is at present limited to the liquids shown in the summary of minimum requirements in chapter 17 of the IDC Code. Products that have been reviewed and determined not to present safety and pol lution hazards to such an extent as to warrant application of the Code are found in chapter 18 of the IBe Code.
The existing text of 1.4.16A is replaced by the following:
Noxious liquid substance means any substance referred to in appendix II of Annex II of the International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, 1973, as modified by the Prot ocol of 1978 relating thereto (MARPOL 73/78) or provisionally assessed under the provisions of regulation 3(4) of that Annex as falling into category A, B, C or D.
The f ollowi ng new 1.4.16C is added after the existing 1.4.16B:
The IBC Code means the International Code for the Construction and Equipment of Ships Carrying Dangerous Chemicals in Bulk adopted by the Maritime Safety Committee and the Marine Environment Protection Committee

The IBC Code means the International Code for the Construction and Equipment of Ships Carrying Dangerous Chemicals in Bulk adopted by the Maritime Safety Committee and the Marine Environment Protection Committee of the Organization by resolutions MSC.4(48) and MEPC.19(22) respectively, as amended.

The existing text of 3.16. 10(a) is replaced by the fol l owing :

filter type respiratory protection is unacceptable;

The following words are inserted after the third sentence of the existing text of 4.7.21;

Remote manual operation should be arranged such that remote starting of pumps supplying the water spray system and remote operation of any normally closed valves in the system can be carried out from a suitable location outside the cargo area, adjacent to the accommodation spaces and readily accessible and operab l e in the event of fire in the areas protected.

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The existing text of 4.10 is amended as follows:

New

4.10 Cargoes protected by add itives

ADOPTION OF AMENDMENTS TO THE CODE FOR THE CONSTRUCTION AND EQUIPMENT OF SHIPS CARRYING DANGEROUS CHEMICALS IN BULK (BCH CODE)- 4 -

The existing text of 4.10 is amended as follows:

New

4.10 Cargoes protected by add itives

4.10.1 Certai n ca r goes with a reference in colu mn 'm' in th e ta ble of chapter VI. by the nat ure of their chemical make-u p, tend under cer t ain conditions of t emperat ure , exposure to ai r or contact with a ca tal ys t. to undergo polymerization, decomposition, oxidation or other chemical chang es. Mitigation of this tendency is carried ou t by introducing small amounts of chemical additives into the liquid cargo or by controlling the cargo tank environment.

4.10.2 No change.

4 .10.3 Care should be taken to ensure th a t these cargoes are s uffi cie ntly pro tected to prevent de l e t erious chemical change at all times during the voyage. Ships carrying such cargoes should be provided with a certificate of protection f rom the manufa cture r and kept during the voyage specifying:

.1 the name and amount of addi tive present;

.2 whether the additive is oxygen-dependent;

.3 date additive was put in the product and duration of

with a certificate of protection f rom the manufa cture r and kept during
the voyage specifying:
.1 the name and amount of addi tive present;
.2 whether the additive is oxygen-dependent;
.3 date additive was put in the product and duration of
effectiveness;
.4 any temperature limitations qua lif ying the add i tive's
effective lifetime; and
.5 the action to be taken should the le ngth of voyage exceed
the effective lifetime of the additive.
4.10.4 Ships using the exc lusion of air as the method of preventing
oxidatio n of the cargo should comply with 2.19.3 .
4.10.5 A product co ntaini ng an oxygen-dependent additive s hould be
carried without inert ion.
4 .1 0 . 6 A, existing 4.10.5 .
4.10.7 M existing 4.10.6.
4.23 is added ., follows:
4.23 Temperature sensors
Temperature sensors should be used to monitor the cargo pump
temperature to detect overheating due to pump failures.
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CHEMICALS IN BULK (BCH CODE)- 5 -
Chapter VI
The existing text of Cha pter VI is replaced by the following:

(adopted on 30 October 1992)
ADOPTION OF AMENDMENTS TO THE CODE FOR THE CONSTRUCTION AND EQUIPMENT OF SHIPS CARRYING DANGEROUS CHEMICALS IN BULK (BCH CODE)- 5 -
Chapter VI
The existing text of Cha pter VI is replaced by the following:
CHAPTER VI - SUMMARY OF MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS
The summary of minimum requirements of the products covered by th e Code is set out in chap ter 17 of the IBC Code.
For the purpose of application of the minimum requirements under this Code. the cross references in the laC Code shown in the left hand column of the following table should be taken to mean references to the BCH Code shown in the right hand column. Where a reference is made in the 8eH Code to co lumn "m" in the table of chapter VI it should be tsken to mean any of t.he columns "mil, lin" and "0" in the table of chapter 11 of the lBe Code.
IBC/BCH CODES CROSS REFERENCES TO THE REQUIREMENTS

IBC Code chapter 17 items	ISC Code reference	BCH Code reference
Ship type (column e)		
1 .. ship type 1	(2.1.2)	(2.2.4(a))
2 ship type 2	(2.1.2)	(2.2.4(b))
3 '" ship type 3	(2.1.2)	(2.2.4(c))
Tank type (column f)		
1 independent tank	(4. 1.ll	(2.3.2)
2 ,. integral tank	(4.1.2)	(2.3.1)

Ship type (column e)
1 .. ship type 1 (2.1.2) (2.2.4(a))
2 ship type 2 (2.1.2) (2.2.4(b))
3 '" ship type 3 (2.1.2) (2.2.4(c))
Tank type (column f)
1 independent tank (4. 1.ll (2.3.2)
2 ,. integral tank (4.1.2) (2.3.1)
G gravity tank (4.1.3) (2.4)
p preS8ure tank (4.1.4)
Tank environmental control
(column h)
Inert~ inerting (9.1.2.ll (2.19.2(a))
Pad: liquid or gas (9.1.2.2) (2.19.2(b))
Dry : drying (9.1.2.3) (2.19.2(c))
Vent: natural or forced (9.1.2.4) (2.19.2(d))
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CHEMICALS IN BULK (BCH CODE)IRC Code chapter 17 items
Electrical equipment
(column i)
NF: non-flammable
product
Yes: Flashpoint
exceeding 60~C
(closed cup)
No: Product having a
a flashp oint not
exceeding 60~C
(closed cup)
Gauging (co lumn j)
0: open gauging
R; restricted gauging
c; closed gauging
I: indirect gauging
Materials and constructi on
(column m)
Respiratory and
eye pr otection
(column n)
- 6 -
Inc Code reference
(10.1.6)
(10.1.6)
(10.1.6)
(13.1.1.1)
(13.1.1.2)
(13.1.1.3)
(13.1.1.3)
Nl
N2
N3
N4
N5
N6
N7

I: indirect gauging
Materials and constructi on
(column m)
Respiratory and
eye pr otection
(column n)
- 6 -
Inc Code reference
(10.1.6)
(10.1.6)
(10.1.6)
(13.1.1.1)
(13.1.1.2)
(13.1.1.3)
(13.1.1.3)
Nl
N2
N3
N4
N5
N6
N7
N8
Z
11
12
13
14
15
E; see 14.2.8
BCH Code reference
Standard electrical
system
Standard electrical
syste m
Special electrical
syste ms
Open device (3.9(a»
Restricted device
(3.9(b))
Closed device (3 . 9(c»
Indirect device
(3.9(d))
4.12. 1
4. 12.2
4.12.3
4.12.4
4.12.5
4.12 . 8
4.12.9
4.12.1, except copper
and copper alloys may
be used
4.12.6
4.12 .7 (a)
4.12.7(b)
4. 12.10
4.12.6 except

aluminium is not
permitted
3.16.10
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Special requirements
(column 0)
Chaptet" VII
- 7 -
IBC Code referen ce
15.1
15.2
15.3
15.4
15.5.1 - 13
15.5.14 - 26
15.6
15.7
15.8
15.9
15.10
15.11
15.12
15 .13
15.14
15.16
15.17
15.18
15.19
15.19.6
15.20
15.21
16.2.6
16.2.7
16.2.8
16.2.9
16.6
16A. 2.2

IBC Code referen ce
15.1
15.2
15.3
15.4
15.5.1 - 13
15.5.14 - 26
15.6
15.7
15.8
15.9
15.10
15.11
15.12
15 .13
15.14
15.16
15.17
15.18
15.19
15.19.6
15.20
15.21
16.2.6
16.2.7
16.2.8
16.2.9
16.6
16A. 2.2

BeH Code referenc e
4.4
4.19
4.1
4.2
4.20.1 - 14
4.20 .1 5 - 27
4.6
4.5
4.7
4.21
4.3
4.8
4.9
4.10
4.11
4.15
4.13.1
4.13.2
4.14
4.14.1
4.22
4.23
5.2.5
5.2.6
5.2.7
5.2.8
4 .18

SA.2.2

The existing text of Chapte r VII is replaced by the follo~ing:

CHAPTER VII - LIST OF CHEMICALS TO WHICH
THE CODE DOES NOT APPLY

The list of chemicals whi ch have been reviewed for their safety and pollution hazards and determined not to present hazards to such an extent as to warrant the application of the Code is set out in chapter 18 of the !Be Code.

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New chapter VIII is added as follows:

CHAPTER VIII - TRANSPORT OF LIQUID CHEMICAL WASTES

8.1 Pr ea mb le

8.1.1 Maritim e transport of liquid chemi cal wastes could present a threat to

New chapter VIII is added as follows:
CHAPTER VIII - TRANSPORT OF LIQUID CHEMICAL WASTES
8.1 Pr ea mb le
8.1.1 Maritim e transport of liquid chemi cal wastes could present a threat to human health and to the environment.
8.1.2 Liquid chemical wastes should, theref ore, be transported in accordance with relevant international conve ntions and recommendations and, in particula r , in the case of maritime transp ort in bulk, with the req uir ements of this Code.
8.2 Definition s
For th e purpose of thi s chapter:
8.2.1 "Liquid chemical wast es " are subs tances, so l utions or mixt ure s. offe re d for s hi pment, con tai ning or con taminate d with one or mo re constituents which are subj ect to the requirements of this Code and f or which no direct use is envisaged but which are carried for dumping, incineration or other methods of disposal other than at sea.
8.2.2 "Transhounda r y movement" means maritime transport of wastes from an area under the national jurisdictio n of one cou ntr y to or through an area under the nati onal jurisdictio n of anothe r cou ntry, or to or

8.2.2 "Transhounda r y movement" means maritime transport of wastes from an area under the national jurisdictio n of one cou ntr y to or through an area under the nati onal jurisdictio n of anothe r cou ntry, or to or through an area not under the national jurisdi ction of any country, provided at least two countr ies are co ncerned by the movement.

8.3 Appl icability

8.3 . 1 The requirements of this chapter are applicable to the transb oundar y movement of liquid chemical wastes in bulk by seagoi ng ships and shou l d be considered in conjunction with all other requ ir ements of this Code.

8.3.2 The require ment s of this chapter do not ap ply to:

.1 wastes derived f r om shipboard ope ra tions which are covered by the requirements of MARPOL 73 /78;

.2 liquid chemical wastes carried by ships engaged in the incineration of such wastes at sea which are covered by chapter 19 of the IBC Code; and

.3 substances, solutiol\s or mi xtures containi ng or contaminated with radioa c tive material s which are subject to the app l icable requirements for radioactive ma te rials.

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.3 substances, solutiol\s or mi xtures containi ng or contaminated
with radioa c tive material s which are subject to the app l icable
requirements for radioactive ma te rials.
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8.4 Permitted shipments
8.4.1 Transboundary movement of wastes is permitted to commence only when:
.1 notification has been sent by the competent authority of the
country of origin, or by the generator or exporter through the
ehannel of the competent authority of the country of origin, to
the country of final destinationi and
.2 the competent authority of the country of or1gLn, having
received the written consent of the country of final
destination stating that the wastes will be safely incinerated
or treated by other methods of disposal, has given
authorization for the movement.
8.S Documentation
8.5.1 In addition to the documentation specified in 5.2 of this Code ships
engaged in transbounclary movement of liquid chemical wastes should
carryon board a waste movement document issued by the competent

8.S Documentation
8.5.1 In addition to the documentation specified in 5.2 of this Code ships engaged in transbounclary movement of liquid chemical wastes should carryon board a waste movement document issued by the competent authority of the country of origin.
8.6 Classification of liquid chemical waates
8.6.1 For the purpose of the protection of the earine environment all liquid chemical wastes transported in bulk should be treated as category A noxious liquid substances, irrespective of the actual evaluated category.
8.7 Carriage and handling of liquid chemical wastes
8.7.1 Liquid chemical wastes should be carried in ships and cargo tanks in accordance with the minimum requirements for liquid chemical wastes specified in chapter 17 of the IBC Code, unless there are clear grounds indicating that the hazards of the wastes would warrant;
.1 carriage in accordance with the ship type l requirements; or
.2 any additional requirements of this Code applicable to the substance or, in case of a mixture, its constituent presenting the predominsnt hazsrd.
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.2 any additional requirements of this Code applicable to the substance or, in case of a mixture, its constituent presenting the predominsnt hazsrd.

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